

# Topgyal Gurung

347-935-9179 | [topgyal.gurung@gmail.com](mailto:topgyal.gurung@gmail.com) | [linkedin.com/in/topgyalgurung](https://www.linkedin.com/in/topgyalgurung) | [github.com/topgyalgurung](https://github.com/topgyalgurung)

## OBJECTIVE

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Aspiring Backend Software Engineer passionate about scalable systems and personalization, with hands-on experience across full-stack development and applied NLP research

## EXPERIENCE

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### Software Engineering Student

June 2024 – May 2025

*Springboard*

*Online*

- Built a full-stack Next.js app with TypeScript, Prisma, and PostgreSQL, simulating scalable backend patterns ([bit.ly/4kHzV5p](https://bit.ly/4kHzV5p))
- Implemented robust backend APIs for authentication, search, and filtering, enabling personalized dashboard experiences
- Designed responsive UI with Tailwind, Material UI, and integrated Google Maps API for location-based services
- Wrote unit and integration tests with Jest and React Testing Library to ensure backend API reliability and frontend resilience across user journeys
- Debugged UI and backend performance issues using Chrome DevTools, server logs, and Postman

### Tech Operations Associate

Nov 2021 – Oct 2022

*Soul Chants Music*

*New York, NY*

- Implemented website updates per CEO direction by modifying site code and managing deployments on Netlify, improving load times and overall reliability
- Streamlined vendor operations by managing contracts and implementing reusable templates via SignNow, reducing administrative bottlenecks and improving turnaround times
- Led end-to-end project planning using Asana and Basecamp, aligning stakeholder goals and deadlines, resulting in successful on-time delivery of multiple cross-department initiatives
- Managed CEO's complex, multi-domain schedule across education, music, and business, ensuring smooth execution of priorities with attention to discretion and detail

### Cybersecurity Curriculum Consultant

Nov 2020 – Feb 2021

*Research Foundation of CUNY*

*New York, NY*

- Curated a hands-on cybersecurity curriculum by combining CloudLab exercises, network security labs, and CTF challenges
- Completed 13 weeks CodePath cybersecurity course through real world labs and Capture the Flag challenges

### Software Developer Intern

Mar 2020 - Aug 2020

*Dextro Software Systems*

*Princeton, NJ*

- Designed and optimized T-SQL queries and stored procedures to support financial reporting, risk analysis, and regulatory compliance
- Developed robust SSIS ETL pipelines to integrate large volumes of transactional and market data from multiple financial systems into a centralized data warehouse
- Built and maintained interactive dashboards in SSRS and Power BI for real-time insights into revenue performance, portfolio health, and key financial KPIs

### Data Engineer Intern

June 2019 – Aug 2019

*Real Factors (acquired by 7Park Data)*

*Queens, NY*

- Resolved geospatial rendering issues using BigQuery SQL and WKT parsing ahead of a key merger
- Integrated internal data catalogs into Apache Superset dashboards, enabling business stakeholders to make data-driven decisions—demonstrating API/data pipeline integration skills relevant to personalization
- Optimized large demographic datasets for visualization and reporting; wrote efficient SQL views, stored procedures, user defined and aggregate functions for GCP BigQuery

### Machine Learning Research Assistant

May 2018 – June 2019

*Hunter College*

*New York, NY*

- Collaborated with professor and senior research fellow to evaluate implementation feasibility of state-of-the-art machine translation models (e.g., CODE-NN)
- Reproduced deep learning models in PyTorch and TensorFlow using remote cloud GPUs (CUNY HPCC), leveraging CUDA for performance optimization
- Conducted model training, hyperparameter tuning, and benchmarking on real-world NLP datasets to validate accuracy and efficiency
- Gained hands-on experience with remote development workflows (SSH), GPU computing, and NLP model evaluation in a research-engineering environment

## EDUCATION

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### Hunter College

New York, NY

*Bachelor's in Computer Science*

## TRAININGS AND CERTIFICATIONS

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### Python for Everybody Specialization, University of Michigan

May 2021 – July 2021

- Learned to program and analyze data with python. Developed programs to clean, analyze, and visualize data

### CodePath Cybersecurity by CodePath

Feb 2021 - Apr 2021

- Gained practical experience in network security, ethical hacking, threat analysis, and secure coding practices
- Identified and exploited common vulnerabilities such as SQL injection, XSS, CSRF, and session hijacking through guided labs and Capture the Flag (CTF) challenges

### CUNY2X TTP x Full Stack Academy

May 2020 - June 2019

- Selected for a 6-week, full-time (40 hrs/week) Full Stack Software Development program led by Fullstack Academy, with a focus on Agile/Scrum methodologies
- Applied JavaScript concepts, DOM manipulation, REST API with hands on projects
- Built with teams full stack web application with React, Redux in frontend and Node, Express and Sequelize ORM for Postgres in backend and deployed in Heroku

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Languages:** Javascript, Typescript, Python, Java

**Frontend:** Next.js, React, HTML/CSS, Tailwind CSS, Material UI

**Backend:** Node.js, Express.js, Next.js API routes, SQL, Flask, GraphQL, REST APIs, Prisma ORM

**Databases:** MongoDB, PostgreSQL

**Developer Tools:** Git, Docker, Vercel, GCP BigQuery, AWS, Figma, CI/CD

**Testing:** Jest, Chai, React Testing Library, TDD

## PROJECTS

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### Himalayan Connect NYC | *Full-Stack Resource Hub*

Feb 2025 – Present

- Designed and built a searchable resource platform using Next.js, PostgreSQL, and Prisma ORM focus on backend design and user-specific resource personalization ([github.com/HimalayanConnectNYC](https://github.com/HimalayanConnectNYC))
- Implemented JWT-based custom authentication and user-specific content filtering
- Emulated scalable backend architecture for personalized user access to community data